

Bluff

YOUR WAY THROUGH

Apple Mac OS X Tiger

There are operating systems and then there's Tiger. In its latest avatar, Mac OS X is faster, better and as graphically appealing as ever. Chances are, though, that you've never used it. There are times when you want to stand out of the crowd and throw jargon, but with a Mac, it isn't straightforward. But that's what we're here for!

Tiger includes a lot of new additions such as *Widgets* and the *Spotlight*. Spotlight is the lightning-fast search technology that displays results as fast as you can type them! You can search everything on your system—files, e-mails, contacts, images, movies, calendars, and even applications. Just say “I'm throwing the spotlight on some files” when you want to talk about searching your desktop!

The new Dashboard (a.k.a. Exposé) hosts a ton of mini-applications called Widgets, which appear instantly and keep you up-to-date with information from the Net. View stocks, check weather forecasts, track flights, convert currencies, even look up businesses in the phone book. Think of it as the inbuilt Google Deskbar. Usage: “Let me check the Dashboard for the latest price of *Digit* stock”. Of course, there is no *Digit* stock—so substitute for that wisely!

And since we'll be bluffing anyway, remember that the Mac OSes are built around the UNIX platform. Here's some worthwhile info you could pass along as you make small talk: “Under the hood, the easy-to-use interface and rich graphics are powered by Darwin, an open source, UNIX-based foundation built on technologies such as Mach and FreeBSD.”

Also, Tiger has significantly improved support for dual-processor performance when reading and writing files to disk and when using Mac OS X with NFS file servers.

A suggestion: memorise!

All In A Month's Work

Each month—this month being no different—the story idea meeting is where it all begins. Brainstorming soon gets us locking horns. Substitute ‘man’ with ‘idea’ in “May the best man win!” and you'd know what we're talking about! To give you an example, just try and point fingers at Opera—it brings out the gladiator in Raaabo.

And receiving the ‘Loudspeaker of the Year’ award at our Diwali party has only reinforced ed Deepak's resolve to use his lung power to get us all cracking!

Then follows the story board meeting, where we tell the design team about our stories. The design team—Pillaiji, Solomon, Vijay, Pradip, Chaitanya, Vikram and Brother Zivalal (real name: Zony Ericsson)—have made life here more colourful, literally! They've put up lifelike sketches and caricatures of *Digit* team members on their pin-up boards. And indeed, passers-by do gaze, admire and even smirk!

And then before we know it, issue-

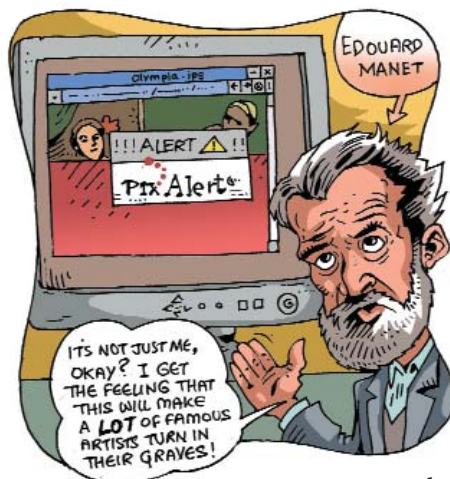
closing has already crept upon us. It's during those late nights that we all turn into armchair theoreticians, raving and ranting about all things under the sun over icy-cold cola and hot pizzas dripping with mozzarella! Such a perfect setting!

For Raaabo and Ram at this time of month, *Digit* is a home away from home. Ram, hypochondriac that he is, keeps his pill-box handy, not to forget his beloved pillow—apart from a jar of powdered caffeine and a ladder of cigarette packs. And you can safely trust Mithun to juggle tasks, big or small—the nearer the deadline, the faster he delivers!

Film aficionado Renuka will share all that she's learning in her script-writing course with anyone who will lend an ear! Sadly, it was also Preethi's last month—with the *Don* of *Digit* gone, it's time we get someone to fill in her shoes!

In fact, we're eagerly awaiting the new members soon to come on board. Watch this space for more on them next month!

DIGIT DIARY



images have in common: skin, and lots of it. And when it comes to porn movies, there's skin-coloured textures that move, without the overall amount of the colour changing much.

According to PixAlert.com, “PixAlert Auditor's Image Analysis Engine

has been proven to

provide results which are 95-98% accurate. The software has been tested on millions of images.”

Actually, the FAQ itself provided us with quite a few laughs, including, as it does, stuff like the following:

“Can PixAlert (also) detect illicit cartoon images?”

“PixAlert Auditor is designed to detect all images but is optimised to detect pornographic images. As a result, PixAlert Auditor will detect life-like cartoon images as being of an illicit nature.”

GET USED TO THEM

Splogs: Spam Reaches Blogs

It had to happen sooner or later, and now it's upon us. Spam has reached the blogosphere, and in a big way. As always, it's all about money, of course.

Since there are so many blogs around, there must be spam-related ways to make money off the idea—and spammers seem to have found at least three such.

“Splog” doesn't have a concrete definition yet, but think about them as spam blogs, or spam postings on blogs, or as anything that's a combination of spam and a blog. Splogs push the same kind of stuff most spam does: Viagra, organ enhancement products, get-rich-quick schemes... you get the idea.

It's a relatively new phenomenon, and most people who visit blogs don't expect anything irrelevant—so there's been a lot of confusion amongst those